

# Policy Transmittal

## Aging and People with Disabilities



Corissa Neufeldt

**Authorized signature**

**Topic:** Protective Services

**Number:** APD-PT-24-028

**Issue date:** 11/21/2024

**Updated date:** 4/24/2025

**Due date:**

**Transmitting (check the box that best applies):**

- ☐ New policy    ☒ Policy change    ☐ Policy clarification    ☐ Executive letter  
☐ Administrative Rule    ☐ Manual update    ☐ Other:

**Applies to (check all that apply):**

- |                                                                        |                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> All DHS employees                             | <input type="checkbox"/> County Mental Health Directors                       |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Area Agencies on Aging: Type B     | <input type="checkbox"/> Health Services                                      |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Aging and People with Disabilities | <input type="checkbox"/> Office of Developmental Disabilities Services (ODDS) |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Self Sufficiency Programs                     | <input type="checkbox"/> ODDS Children's Intensive In Home Services           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> County DD program managers                    | <input type="checkbox"/> Stabilization and Crisis Unit (SACU)                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Support Service Brokerage Directors           | <input type="checkbox"/> Other ( <i>please specify</i> ):                     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> ODDS Children's Residential Services          |                                                                               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Child Welfare Programs                        |                                                                               |

|                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                  |  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|--|
| Policy/rule title:     | APS Screening Decisions: Documentation and Notification to Reporters                                                                                                                                                 |                  |  |
| Policy/rule number(s): | OAR Chapter 411, Division 020, Adult Protective Services                                                                                                                                                             | Release number:  |  |
| Effective date:        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Expiration date: |  |
| References:            | <a href="#">APD-APS-040-001 Timeframes and Deviations</a><br><a href="#">QRG - Documenting APS Screening Decisions and Notification to Reporters</a><br><a href="#">Documenting a Screening Decision – APS Guide</a> |                  |  |
| Web address:           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                  |  |

## **Discussion/interpretation:**

Updates are being implemented related to documentation of screening decisions and notification to reporters following a recent internal audit by the Oregon Department of Human Services internal audits unit.

This policy transmittal is effective immediately and changes the process for how to document when a reporter is notified in CAM.

## **APS SCREENING DECISIONS: DOCUMENTATION AND NOTIFICATION TO REPORTERS**

### **A. SCREENING DECISION DOCUMENTATION:**

1. Local APS staff must document a clear and comprehensive explanation for all screening decisions in CAM. Pursuant to policy, *APD-APS-040-001 Timeframes and Deviations*, the following applies:
  - a. Screening, as defined in [OAR 411-020-0060](#), begins upon receipt of a report of suspected abuse or self-neglect by the local office. A report of abuse is considered to have been “received,” and screening begun, on the date and at the time of its receipt, if received during Business Hours. After Business Hours, the report is considered to have been received at the beginning of the next Business Day (8:00 AM to 5:00 PM Monday through Friday, excluding holidays as determined by the state).
  - b. A screening decision (i.e., whether the report of abuse or self-neglect meets criteria for investigation) is required to be made no later than the end of the next Business Day following the day of receipt of the report.
2. For all intakes with allegations, the rationale for the screening decision must be documented in the “Reason for Screening Decision Detail” field in CAM.
3. For all non-abuse intakes, the rationale for the screening decision must be documented under the “Additional Notes” field in CAM.

Examples and instructions are available in *QRG - APS Screening Decisions: Documentation and Notification to Reporters*.

4. Enough detail must be provided so that a reviewer can understand why the screening decision was made and what available information and screening-related rules and policies were used to reach the screening decision.

- a. The following information must be documented in the CAM intake for the screening decision, as applicable, and as described in the QRG above:
  - i. Information regarding the alleged victim's (AV's) eligibility, including age, reported disability, location of the reported incident, etc.
  - ii. The nature of the reported incident or conduct, and the reasoning for why the allegation didn't meet the APS definition of abuse.
  - iii. APS rule and policy citations relevant to the screening decision.
  - iv. References to any supplemental information available to the screener from other sources (collateral contacts, databases such as CAM and Oregon Access, etc.) that supports the screening decision.

## **B. REPORTER NOTIFICATION & DOCUMENTATION:**

1. Local APS staff must consistently notify reporters of screening decisions and document in CAM that they have done so. If more than one person reports the same concern, all persons making the report are reporters and receive notification.
2. Local APS staff must notify the reporter of the screening decision no later than the end of the next Business Day following the screening decision. If the first attempt is unsuccessful, a second attempt must be made by the end of the second Business Day following receipt of the report.
  - a. Notification may occur in the same way the report was made, e.g., by telephone if the initial report was made by phone, by email if the initial report was made by email, etc. If staff leave a voicemail or send an email as part of the first notification attempt, advising the reporter of the screening decision and providing the CAM intake number and a contact number for calling back, a second attempt at notification is not necessary.
  - b. Contacting the reporter with the screening decision must be documented in the CAM intake detail as identified in QRG - APS Screening Decisions: Documentation and Notification to Reporters.
  - c. Intakes should never be left open or not assigned while attempts to reach the reporter to provide notification are underway. Once an attempt to notify the reporter is made and documented, the intake can be closed in CAM, even if the attempt wasn't successful. Intakes assigned for investigation cannot be

closed in CAM until an attempt to notify the reporter has occurred and been documented.

3. Notification of the screening decision is not required as described below, If the reporter is:
  - a. A routine cross-report from a public safety entity, e.g., law enforcement, fire, or emergency medical services. However, local offices are expected to confirm notification expectations with the local public safety entities to avoid misunderstandings;
  - b. Reports transmitted in writing from an entity with no identified contact person;
  - c. Reports from any reporter who requests to not receive notification;
  - d. A routine facility self-report of an incident.

### **C. QUALITY ASSURANCE REVIEWS:**

1. Central APS will conduct periodic quality assurance reviews of CAM intakes and share the results with local APS offices, beginning in early 2025.
2. The screening quality assurance review will look at timeliness of screening decisions, timeliness of screening notifications, and thoroughness of documentation of screening decisions.
3. Performance targets will be set, and corrective actions by local APS offices will be required when they perform below the performance targets.

### **Implementation/transition instructions:**

On March 20, 2025, a CAM Refinement was implemented that changed fields under the intake detail page in CAM.

**Details**

Victim's Name: [REDACTED]

Intake Number: 00002947

Intake Number Provided to Reporter: ☐

Date Screening Decision Provided to Rptr: [REDACTED]

Reporter Screening Decision Notes: [REDACTED]

Date/Time Opened: 7/11/2018 8:00 AM

Responsible County: Marion

Responsible Program: APS

Investigative Authority: [REDACTED]

**Current "Date Screening Decision Provided to Reporter" Remove this date field and change this to a drop-down field.**

**New Field Label:** "Screen Decision to Reporter Outcome":

**Drop-down Values:** Successfully Provided ; Not Provided Due to Exception ; Attempted Unsuccessfully

**New Help Text:** - Choose "Successfully Provided" if the Screening Decision was provided to the reporter. Choose "Not Provided Due to Exception" when decision was not provided due to an exception outlined in OAR such as FSR or LEA reason ; Choose "Attempted Unsuccessfully" when decision was not provided but attempts were made.

**Validation:** This field should be required to be completed prior to closing an intake or closing an investigation.

**Update Help Text to the "Reporter Screening Decision Notes".**

**New Help Text:** Capture notes of attempts to provide screening decision to all reporters and results of successfully providing screening decision to reporter here. OR Capture notes of reasons why screening decision was not provided to reporter and the reason for the exception or unsuccessful attempt.

This refinement was added in a continued effort to create system efficiencies in the data entry requirements for APS staff. The QRG referenced in this policy transmittal has also been updated. Additionally, a new resource (Documenting a Screening Decision – APS Guide) is available to assist in applying the basic elements of a screening decision as described in this policy.

### **Training/communication plan:**

The policy transmittal will be posted at the [APS Staff Tools](#) website, [APD's Transmittals](#) website, and the CAM Knowledge tab with other APS policy transmittals. Communication and discussion regarding this policy transmittal will occur during APS supervisor meetings, APS Training, and other venues as needed. Requests for technical assistance on applying this policy transmittal should be sent to the Central APS Unit at [APS.TechAssistance@odhsoha.oregon.gov](mailto:APS.TechAssistance@odhsoha.oregon.gov).

### **Local/branch action required:**

Please discuss these changes with staff during huddles and staff meetings. Ensure local APS staff awareness of the policy transmittal and where it is posted on the [APD Transmittals Public Facing](#) website.

### **Central office action required:**

Respond to inquiries regarding this policy transmittal as needed.

**Field/stakeholder review:** ☒ Yes ☐ No

**If yes, reviewed by:** APS Supervisors, Central APS Unit

### **Filing instructions:**

*If you have any questions about this policy, contact:*

|                                                                                                         |      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Contact(s): APD Central Office APS Unit Technical Assistance                                            |      |
| Phone:                                                                                                  | Fax: |
| Email: <a href="mailto:APS.TechAssistance@odhsoha.oregon.gov">APS.TechAssistance@odhsoha.oregon.gov</a> |      |